



Keith
Speaking
Academy

WHY YOU CAN'T SPEAK ENGLISH FLUENTLY



KEITH O'HARE



Helping you Become a Confident English Speaker



Many IELTS students lack confidence in their speaking skills.

The Keith Speaking Academy helps you develop your speaking skills so you can face the examiner with confidence and ace the IELTS test.

This PDF is one of many that Keith has developed to help you do this.

Keith has been working in international education for over 20 years as a teacher, teacher trainer, and education manager.

He has helped over 40,000 students prepare for their IELTS Speaking test with his online courses.

Introduction

Are you struggling to speak English fluently?

Maybe you can understand lots when you listen, but your mind goes blank when it comes to speaking.

You're not alone in this journey. Many people who are learning English and preparing for the IELTS Speaking test find that fluency is one of the hardest things to achieve.

As someone who has taught over 40,000 students globally, I've seen these challenges firsthand.

In this lesson, I will discuss 6 reasons why you might not be speaking English fluently yet. I will also provide some tips on what you can do to improve your fluency.

1. You are trying too hard to impress

One of the biggest mistakes that people make when learning a new language is that they try too hard to impress others. This often leads to speaking too quickly which can result in a loss of control over your speech. It's a common misconception that faster speaking equates to better fluency.

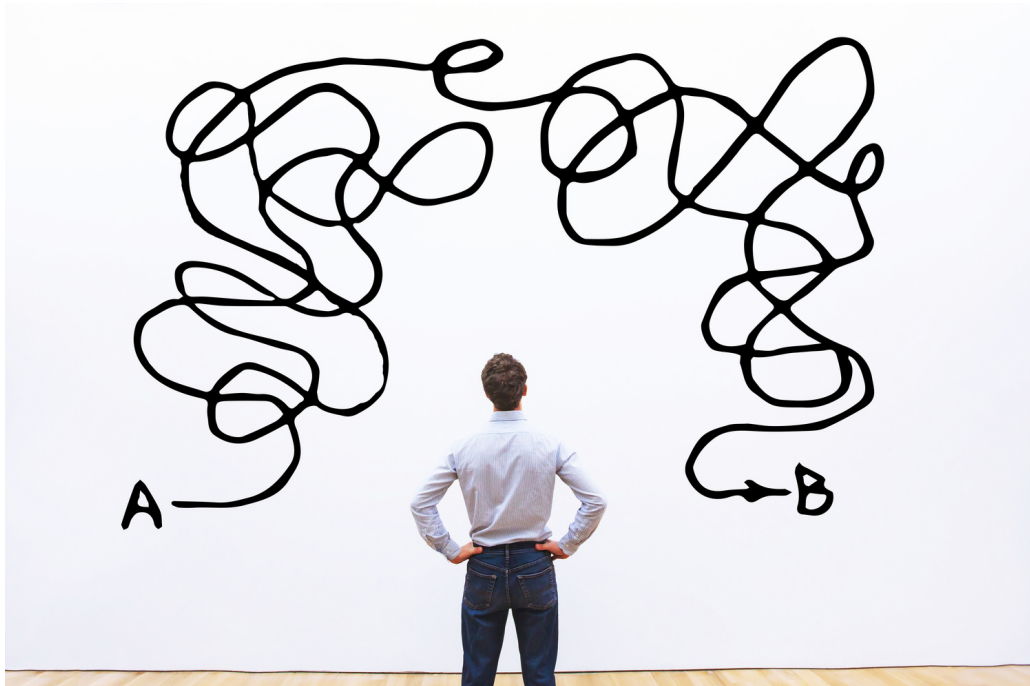
Instead, focus on speaking at your own pace and communicating clearly. It's better to speak slowly and correctly than to speak quickly and make mistakes.



2. You are making things over-complicated

Many learners believe that using complex vocabulary and sentences will showcase their proficiency. However, this approach can backfire, causing more confusion and slowing down your speech. The complexity of your language might be hindering your fluency.

Instead, keep your sentences simple and use vocabulary that you are comfortable with. It's also important to use phrases and sentence structures that are natural to spoken English and don't sound like written English.



3. You are focussing on Accuracy

It's important to be accurate when you are speaking English, but it's also important to be fluent. If you are constantly trying to avoid mistakes, it will slow you down and make it difficult to speak naturally.

Instead, focus on communicating your ideas clearly. It's okay to make a few mistakes along the way. Get a balance between accuracy and fluency.



4. You lack vocabulary

One of the biggest challenges to fluency is having a limited vocabulary. When you don't know the words you need to express yourself, it can be difficult to speak smoothly and confidently.

There are a number of things you can do to improve your vocabulary. One is to read as much as possible. You can also watch movies and TV shows in English, and listen to English music and podcasts. The main thing is to see vocabulary as an ongoing, long-term activity. It is something you need to stick to over time.



5. You are shy

Shyness can be a major obstacle to fluency. If you are shy, you may be afraid to speak up in class or participate in conversations.

It might lead to mumbling or poor body language, which in turn can make your speech less clear and confident.

There are a few things you can do to make sure shyness doesn't affect your fluency. The first is to make shyness your friend. You need to realise you can be shy and still speak fluently. It just needs practice. Practice speaking English with friends or family. You can also join an English conversation club or take an online speaking course. Take it step by step, and be patient and kind to yourself.



6. You don't practice enough

Often, there's a misconception that any practice will help your fluency. However, not doing practice that focuses specifically on fluency can be a problem.

Regular speaking practice doesn't always translate to fluently expressing ideas or smoothly transitioning from one thought to another. First of all, become more familiar with natural phrasing that native speakers use. How do they break up their sentences into shorter phrases or blocks? How do they use intonation effectively over longer sentences?

You can learn this by **listening to interviews** and noticing the pauses, intonation and phrasing. What's more, you can try shadowing sentences from such interviews, imitating native speaker phrasing. You could also check out my online course *Fluent Grammar for IELTS Speaking*, which focuses exactly on this; phrasing and intonation and building it up effectively across different tenses and longer sentences.

Conclusion

I hope this lesson has helped you to understand the reasons why you might not be speaking English fluently yet.

Understanding these challenges is the first step towards overcoming them. Each of these points highlights a different aspect of learning that might need your attention.

Reflect on these reasons and consider how they might apply to you. Remember, the path to fluency is as much about recognising what's holding you back as it is about practicing the right way. The next step for you is to take action. Choose areas to focus on and take some action.

The most important thing is to remember that fluency takes time and effort. Don't get discouraged if you don't see results immediately. Just keep practicing and you will eventually reach your fluency goals.

Which of these challenges do you relate to the most?

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Speaking here:**

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